

MARCUS VAN DER MEER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 14 years building and scaling backend systems at high-growth companies. I've led teams through major architectural decisions, mentored junior engineers, and owned critical infrastructure projects from conception to production. My focus is on writing clean, maintainable code and making sure the technical decisions we make today don't become tomorrow's headaches.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, JavaScript, SQL

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, DynamoDB, Cassandra

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud, Docker, Kubernetes

Architectures: Microservices, Event-Driven Systems, CQRS

Tools and Frameworks: gRPC, Protocol Buffers, Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ

DevOps: Terraform, Helm, CI/CD pipelines, GitHub Actions

Areas of Expertise: System Design, Performance Optimization, Team Leadership, Code Review, API Design

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Nexus Systems

<https://nexussystems.io>

Amsterdam, Netherlands

March 2021 - Present

Led architectural redesign of payment processing system that reduced latency by 65% and increased throughput to handle 50k requests per second during peak hours

Mentored 5 junior and mid-level engineers on system design principles, code quality standards, and production debugging techniques through weekly sessions and code reviews

Owned migration of monolithic application to microservices architecture, establishing clear service boundaries and communication patterns that reduced deployment friction by 80%

Established observability standards across the platform including structured logging, distributed tracing, and custom metrics that cut mean time to resolution from 4 hours to 15 minutes

Senior Software Engineer

Dataflow Technologies

<https://dataflow.tech>

Amsterdam, Netherlands

July 2017 - February 2021

Designed and implemented real-time data streaming pipeline processing 2 billion events daily, selected Apache Kafka for distributed processing with custom partitioning strategies based on query patterns

Built internal platform for managing PostgreSQL clusters across multiple cloud regions, enabling teams to provision databases on-demand while maintaining consistency and backups

Reduced database query response times by 40% through index optimization and refactoring N+1 queries, collaborating with product teams to understand access patterns before optimization

Conducted weekly tech talks covering distributed systems topics, Go patterns, and database internals that became foundational knowledge shared across 40+ person engineering team

Software Engineer

Innovate Solutions B.V.

<https://innovatesolutions.net>

The Hague, Netherlands

June 2010 - June 2017

Developed and maintained Java backend services serving 5 million monthly active users, implementing caching strategies and query optimization that improved page load times from 800ms to 200ms

Implemented RESTful API standards and versioning strategy adopted company-wide, reducing integration issues and creating clear contracts between frontend and backend teams

Led on-call rotation and incident response, establishing post-mortems and blameless culture that reduced critical incidents by 30% through root cause analysis and preventive measures

Mentored 3 junior engineers as they progressed from entry-level to mid-level positions, providing guidance on technical growth and career development

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science

University of Amsterdam

Amsterdam, Netherlands

2008 - 2010

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Erasmus University Rotterdam

Rotterdam, Netherlands

2005 - 2008

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

<https://github.com/mvdermeer/kafka-partitioner> - Custom Kafka partition strategy library with examples for event routing in high-volume systems

<https://github.com/mvdermeer/postgres-migration-tool> - Tool for managing PostgreSQL migrations across multiple environments with validation

<https://github.com/mvdermeer/observability-patterns> - Collection of Go patterns and examples for structured logging and distributed tracing

<https://github.com/mvdermeer/grpc-load-balancing> - Benchmarks and implementations of load balancing strategies for gRPC services